

**Report: Onsite audit walk DPE consultant: Stuart Lee (SL) School :
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An onsite visit took place on the 17th May 2023. In addition to reviewing compliance actions, a physical audit walk was completed. A physical audit is useful in supporting the school with physical data risks and remedial actions, including signposting to the latest DPE best practice areas.

Audit walk feedback

Good practice was generally observed with minimal data on display. Folder and online systems used for sharing data securely. CPOMS is used for Safeguarding; coat pegs displayed forename only; lists displayed forename only and there was minimal data on display in classrooms. Offices where sensitive data is stored have key code entry and entry is restricted to authorised staff only. Sensitive folders are added to secure storage.

The following documents/best practice areas on the DPE website can be used to reference against and to obtain additional resources detailed in the report:

- [DPE compliance documents/consent guidance](#)
- [DPE quick reference guide](#)
- [Records management best practice](#)
- [Information and cyber security](#)
- [Acceptable use and bring your own device \(BYOD\)](#)

Audit walk observations and recommendations are detailed below:

Visitor sign in

Recommendations: Add the following statement to the visitor sign in system: Visitor information is collected for health and safety, record of official visits and safeguarding. If you would like to know more, the general/visitors privacy notice is available on the school website, or you can ask at reception for a paper copy (paper copy could go on the notice board). More guidance regarding visitor sign in systems is available [here](#).

Reception/visitor area - photocopier

No secure code to photocopier(s).

Recommendation: Review and consider adding secure codes so that staff only print when at the printer rather than leaving printing on the device, causing a potential data breach. It adds security for printing confidential files as they can only be printed by the owner of the file. It also reduces the amount printed, saving paper and money.

Reception/admin office

Areas were clear of clutter. Shredders/bins used for securely destroying sensitive data. There were limited secure filing cabinets, however, there is secure code entry with restricted access and sensitive files are kept securely.

Recommendation: Continue to investigate moving from physical lists to online registers/systems i.e. registers/club lists.

Headteacher's office

The headteacher office has key code entry with restricted access, adequate secure storage and sensitive files are kept securely.

Classrooms

Some sensitive data was observed; assessment/intervention and behaviour plans. Some desks would benefit from a declutter and the back of some classroom door(s) were used to display sensitive data.

Recommendations:

- Remind staff to add any folders that contain sensitive data (assessment/intervention etc) to available storage (end of day routines).
- Practise a clear desk policy and continue to complete a data cleanse of classrooms/cupboards checking for outdated and incorrectly labelled information.
- Remove sensitive data from the back of cupboard doors and add to folders; securing where possible in cabinets/cupboards.

Corridors

Photos without names.

Laptops and iPads

Some staff use their own laptops and classroom iPads do not have secure access codes.

Laptop recommendations

Ideally staff would/should use organisational laptops although budget constraints are a barrier at present. The school has discussed with their IT provider and utilises the Cloud to minimise data being downloaded and/or being stored on personal devices.

- Complete a risk assessment (if not already) and review risks with the schools IT providers i.e. what mitigations are in place to avoid malware downloads via the school WIFI etc. DPE will be happy to support the process via DPE's record of processing/risk assessment tool.
- Adopt DPE's [BYOD/work away from school](#) documentation and/or update existing school documentation to ensure this is as robust as possible.
- Advise staff regarding best practice to ensure no organisational data is retained on personal devices i.e. delete downloads from personal devices and only access via the Cloud (avoiding downloads) etc. Share with staff any updated/new policy documentation. Continue to raise awareness of risks and ensure personal devices are encrypted with the latest anti virus software installed.
- Consider additional training for staff i.e DPE's [NCSC Cyber security training for school staff](#) and [Password nugget training](#)

Note: I would also review school insurance regarding personal devices being damaged at work. Also, check out DPE's [Information and cyber security](#) best practice area.

iPad recommendations:

Add secure codes to prevent unauthorised access.